

Michael Cerny Green

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PERSONAL STATEMENT

AI researcher, engineer, and product leader. With a PhD in Artificial Intelligence from NYU and over 30 peer-reviewed publications, I specialize in translating cutting-edge research in AI to solving real-world problems, especially around optimizing the way we work. Currently, I am managing the product portfolio backlog of an Azure-based data platform with a team of over 50 engineers. I play a strategic role in discovering, planning, and executing organizational change for AI-agent assisted workflows. As a public speaker, educator, and thought leader, I excel at simplifying complex AI concepts, whether presenting at global conferences like CES, solutioning with business leaders, or lecturing in university classrooms. I strive to empower my team to innovate faster, reach higher, and work smarter. My research field is in procedural content generation using AI algorithms.

WORK EXPERIENCE:

Senior Technical Product Manager, Optimal Dynamics, Remote

Aug 2022-Now

Product management of a 15+ person development team building the Dispatch/Execute and AI user-facing experiences of the platform.

- Own product strategy across multiple initiatives under the platform's optimization roadmap, spanning dispatch decisioning, deployment quality, and AI-driven decision support
- Led the redesign of dispatch calibration, replacing legacy exception-based logic with a distribution-aware approach for enterprise freight customers
- Drove a release-quality initiative to enact automated nightly verification as a trusted signal for all deployments.
- Defined and shipped inline AI recommendation cards that surface dispatch decision support at assignment time, pivoting the team from a pure chat-based explainability approach

Director of Product Management, Hitachi Solutions America, Remote

Aug 2022-Jan 2026

Product management of a 50+ person development team building the Empower Data Platform.

- Strategic vision and execution of a multi-million-dollar annual budget for a self-service data orchestration product built on Azure and Databricks.
- Top-of-funnel demo creation, product pitching, public speaking (NRF-23, HIMMS-23, DAIS-23-24, CES-25), and blogging (1, 2).
- Leading product management team through user research and buildout of solutions for data streams and artificial intelligence workflows.
- Led cross-functional initiatives to upskill the organization in leveraging agentic tools, fostering adaptability and proficiency in an AI-enhanced workplace.

Adjunct Professor, New York University, Brooklyn, NY

Jan 2023-Dec 2024

Parttime adjunct professorship at the Tandon School of Engineering -- Video Game Design (CS-GY 4553/CS-UY 6553)

- 4.5/5 average overall satisfaction score amongst 70 students across two semesters.

Artificial Intelligence Engineering Lead, Origen.AI, Brooklyn, NY

Nov 2018-Feb 2022

Founding employee of a private, AI-applied technology platform developing models for the energy industry.

- Managed platform deployment projects capturing ~\$300k revenue (FY20) and \$1M (FY21).
- Pitched investors to close ~\$1M seed round (FY21).
- Built and maintained a cloud-agnostic AI R&D framework (Python, PyTorch/Lightning, NVIDIA GPU compute, Docker).
- Built a scalable AI/ML research pipeline for rapid multi-GPU model training (Neptune, AWS Batch, S3).
- Peer-reviewed papers detailing new network paradigms to solve non-linear partially differentiable equations using **attention mechanisms** (<https://arxiv.org/pdf/2105.07898.pdf>), published in **Nature** (<https://www.nature.com/articles/s41598-022-11058-2>).

EDUCATION:

New York University, New York, NY

PhD – Artificial Intelligence

Aug 2016-June

2022

AI can do more than just learn from us. I build AI that can generate personalized, educational content.

Lehigh University, Bethlehem, PA

B.S. – Computer Science and Business, B.A. – Classical Civilizations

Aug 2012-May 2016

PROFICIENCIES AND SKILLS:

Leadership: Team Management, Mentorship, Public Speaking, Program Design & OKRs, Executive Communication

Technical: AI (supervised, unsupervised, tree search, evolutionary, embeddings), Azure (ai and data), Python, Pytorch, Data Lakehouse (Databricks, DLT, RAG, Fabric, Delta)

Product: Product Management, Solution Requirements, Marketing, Go-To-Market Strategy, Pitches, Demos

Hobbies: Competitive Sailboat Racing, Gardening, Sourdough Breadmaking, Video Game Design

CITATIONS AND RESEARCH:

Procedural Content Generation

Automated generation of content using tree search, evolutionary optimization, or machine learning.

- [\[2023\] Level Generation through Large Language Models](#) – Graham Todd, Sam Earle, Muhammad Umair Nasir, Michael Cerny Green, Julian Togelius - FDG 2023
- [\[2022\] Learning Controllable 3D Level Generators](#) – Zehuah Jiang, Sam Earle, Michael Cerny Green, Julian Togelius
- [\[2022\] Persona-driven Dominant/Submissive Map \(PDSM\) Generation](#) – Michael Cerny Green, Ahmed Khalifa, M Charity, and Julian Togelius – FDG 2022
- [\[2020\] Mech-Elites: Illuminating the Mechanic Space of GVG-AI](#) - M Charity, Michael Cerny Green, Ahmed Khalifa, and Julian Togelius - FDG 2020
- [\[2020\] Mario Level Generation From Mechanics Using Scene Stitching](#) – Michael Cerny Green, Luvneesh Mugrai, Ahmed Khalifa, and Julian Togelius – CoG 2020
- [\[2019\] Intentional Computational Level Design](#) - Ahmed Khalifa, Michael Cerny Green, Gabriella Barros, Julian Togelius - IJCAI 2019
- [\[2018\] AtDelfi: Automatically Designing Legible, Full Instructions for Games](#) - Michael Cerny Green, Ahmed Khalifa, Gabriella A. B. Barros, Tiago Machado, Andy Nealen, and Julian Togelius - FDG 2018 – **BEST PAPER AWARD**
- [\[2018\] Generating Levels That Teach Mechanics](#) - Michael Cerny Green, Ahmed Khalifa, Gabriella A. B. Barros, Andy Nealen, and Julian Togelius - PCG Workshop at FDG 2018
- [\[2017\] “Press Space To Fire”: Automatic Video Game Tutorial Generation](#) – Michael Cerny Green, Ahmed Khalifa, Gabriella A. B. Barros, and Julian Togelius – EXAG Workshop at AIIDE 2017.

Automated Agents

Artificial agents that can play/win/explore.

- [\[2020\] Bootstrapping Conditional Gans for Video Game Level Generation](#) - Ruben Rodriguez-Torrado, Ahmed Khalifa, Michael Cerny Green, Niels Justesen, Sabastien Risi, and Julian Togelius - COG 2020
- [\[2019\] Two-step Constructive Approaches for Dungeon Generation](#) - Michael Cerny Green, Ahmed Khalifa, Athoug Alsoughayer, Divyesh Surana, Antonios Liapis, and Julian Togelius - PCG Workshop at FDG 2019
- [\[2019\] Evolutionarily-Curated Curriculum Learning for Deep Reinforcement Learning Agents](#) - Michael Cerny Green, Benjamin Sergeant, Pushyami Shandilya, and Vibhor Kumar - RL Workshop at AAAI 2019
- [\[2018\] Automated Playtesting with Procedural Personas through Evolution Based MCTS](#) - Christoffer Holmgard, Michael Cerny Green, Antonios Liapis, and Julian Togelius - TOG 2018

Analytics and Statistical Analysis

Analyzing users/players and their behaviors.

- [\[2022\] Predicting Personas Using Mechanic Frequencies and Game State Traces](#) – Michael Cerny Green, Ahmed Khalifa, M Charity, Debosmita Bhaumik, and Julian Togelius – WCCI 2022
- [\[2021\] Game Mechanic Alignment Theory](#) - Michael Cerny Green, Ahmed Khalifa, Philip Bontrager, Rodrigo Canaan, and Julian Togelius - FDG 20201
- [\[2019\] Automatic Critical Mechanic Discovery Using Playtraces in Video Games](#) - Michael Cerny Green, Ahmed Khalifa, Gabriella A. B. Barros, Tiago Machado, and Julian Togelius - FDG 2019

30+ published papers available upon request. Please see website for more.

EDUCATIONAL COMMITTEES:

Conference Peer-Review Boards

<i>Foundations of Digital Games (FDG)</i>	2018-2025
<i>Conference on Games (COG)</i>	2019-2022
<i>Procedural Content Generation Workshop at Foundation of Digital Games (PCG)</i>	2019-2022
<i>Portuguese Conference on Artificial Intelligence (EPLA)</i>	2019
<i>User Experience of Artificial Intelligence (UXOFAI)</i>	2019-2021

Scientific Journal Peer Review Boards

<i>Transactions on Games (TOG)</i>	2018-2022, 2024
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